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WE CHOOSE DIFFICULT businesses, but they are also the right businesses to be in,” says Anil Agarwal.

Few sectors test that conviction like natural resources, where fortunes are shaped as much by commodity cycles and regulation as by operational execution. Agarwal, the founder of the Vedanta Group, has spent decades navigating both. Now, after restructuring Vedanta Ltd into five separate listed companies, he is preparing for his next big wager—a \$20-billion investment plan over the next three-five years, funded largely through internal cash generation.

Based in London, he makes time in Mumbai for a chat with *Business Today* on the eve of public listing of the new companies. This follows a demerger of Vedanta Ltd, the listed entity that he heads as the Non-Executive Chairman. The stated rationale is unlocking shareholder value, though reducing debt at Vedanta Resources—the holding company—is equally critical.

Agarwal is known for his ambition and tenacity. It’s no different this time. He believes each of the five listed entities—Vedanta Aluminium, Vedanta Iron & Steel, Vedanta Oil & Gas, Vedanta Power and Vedanta Ltd—can become a \$100-billion revenue company.

The ambition is underpinned by a portfolio of market-leading businesses. Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL) is the world’s largest integrated zinc producer and commands nearly 74% of India’s primary zinc market. Vedanta Aluminium is India’s largest aluminium producer and the third-largest globally, backed by a fully integrated operating model. Vedanta Oil & Gas is the country’s largest private sector crude oil producer with a strong asset base, while Vedanta Power is the



METAL IN INDIA Molten state of aluminum filler metal

THE SCALE

➤ **A \$20-billion investment plan over the next 3-5 years would be funded through internal cash generation**

➤ **Vedanta Iron & Steel benefits from strategically located assets near key raw materials and ports**

➤ **Anil Agarwal believes each of the five listed entities can become a \$100 billion revenue company**

➤ **The copper business has a diversified asset base across markets where demand remains strong**

➤ **Vedanta Oil & Gas is the largest private-sector crude oil producer with a strong asset base, while Vedanta Power is the fifth-largest private thermal power producer**

➤ **The five independent listed entities give the parent company the option to monetise stakes. Selling stake is difficult for a bigger entity**